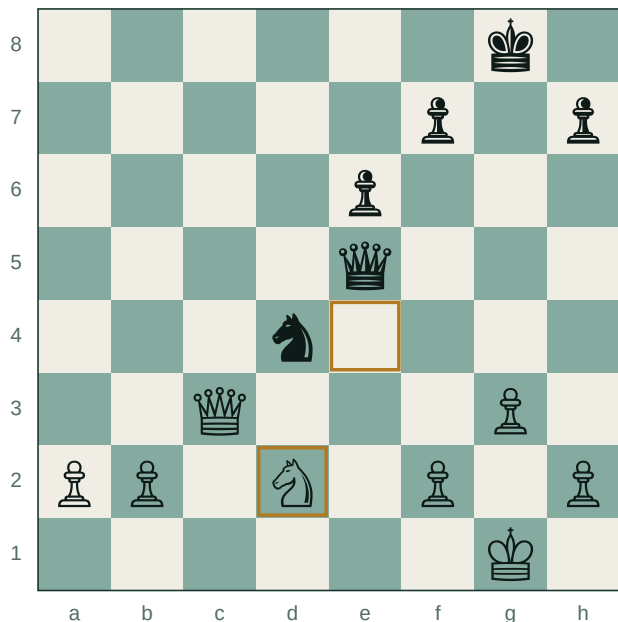


Forks and double attacks: Black, move 37

Forks and double attacks

Black to move



Previous move: 37.Nd2. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

37...Ne2+ 38. Kf1 Nxc3

37...Ne2+ Check restricts White to 3 legal replies here. From e2 it attacks king on g1 and queen on c3. Recorded reply: **38.Kf1**.

38...Nxc3 The knight captures the queen on c3.

At the end, nominal material is White 8 / Black 15 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +9. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer: +9:** the balance goes from -2 to +7. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

Two attacked pieces do not guarantee a gain if the forking piece can be captured or one target moves with check.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

A fork attacks multiple targets at once. The combination works when the defender cannot save everything or generate a stronger forcing reply.

HOW TO LOOK

Look for checking forks first, then double attacks on queens, rooks, and undefended pieces. Follow the line until the material is actually collected.

The defending king is on g1. Look for a defender that can be displaced or overloaded.